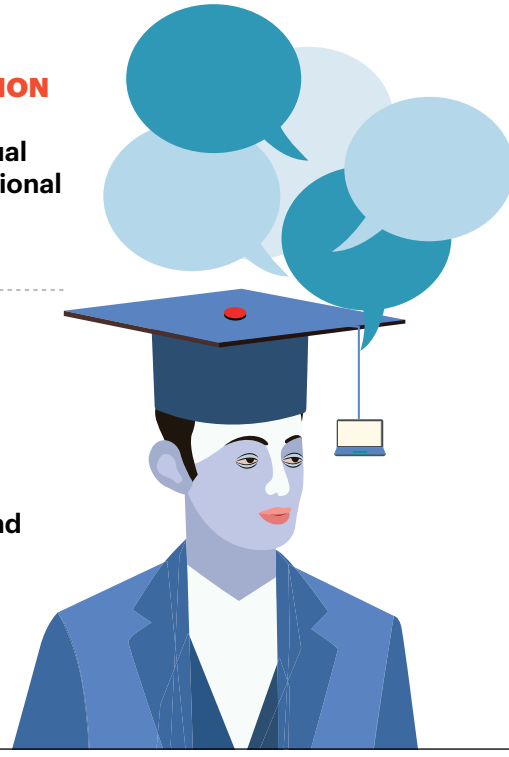
THE B-SCHOOL DEBATE
BILINGUAL MBA VS LANGUAGE SUPPORT



THE HYBRID SOLUTION
Informal bilingual support for conceptual mastery plus professional English training for workplace readiness

HOW IT WORKS
A student could master complex financial concepts in Hindi or Tamil to ensure absolute conceptual depth, and subsequently learn how to explain those exact findings to an investor in London in clear English.

THE HICCUP
While AI can remove reading and translation barriers, it cannot replace the core interpersonal attributes required for senior corporate leadership.

THE VISION
Technology-enabled bilingual management education to expand accessibility

THE REALITY
Logistical challenges across 25+ regional languages, lack of regional business textbooks, and international student integration

network. Professional working proficiency in English remains important for many roles that involve cross-border collaboration and client delivery. For them, proficiency in Indian languages is a valuable strength when working with clients, communities, policymakers, and institutions at central, state, and local levels.

"Our hiring approach focuses first on the capabilities required for the role. These include domain knowledge, learning agility, ambition, confidence, and alignment with Deloitte's shared values rather than treating fluency in English as a proxy for competence potential," says Sagar.

This non-traditional focus is already yielding results. Sagar points to a colleague who grew up in rural Tripura with a modest agricultural background. Driven by pure grit, he built his credentials and joined Deloitte's Bhubaneswar office. Today, he works in the firm's Cyber Defence and Resilience team in Mumbai and recently celebrated his first career promotion.

Nathan S.V., former Country Leader for PwC Acceleration Centres in India and Co-Founder of Vidwon Consulting LLP, notes that requirements vary by function. Sales, marketing and investor relations demand high English proficiency because of client exposure, while technical functions such as software engineering, manufacturing, accounting and supply chain prioritise functional output over linguistic polish.

"If I can communicate what is on my mind, and English is not my strength, but my strength is accounting or technology or manufacturing, that does not hinder career progression in Indian firms," Nathan says. "Language is not a proxy for competence." However, executive search experts note that the English barrier often reappears when mid-level managers try to cross into senior management, profit and loss (P&L) ownership, board interactions, and CXO roles.

"After someone has delivered for a year or two, accent and polish matter far less," explains Mangalwedhe. "The barrier comes back later, when the work turns into managing people, owning a P&L, talking to investors, or sitting in a CXO room